

Grace With Hard People

40 min • May Week 2

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish between difficult people and unsafe people, and practice maintaining a grace posture toward the former while protecting themselves from the latter.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills: grace with difficult people • Self-Management: distinguishing difficult from unsafe
SCENARIO CARDS	Hard People Cards A (The Persistent Critic) & B (The Complicated History)
QUICK REVIEW	1–2 min: "Grace Challenge check-in — who did all three of their commitments every day this week?" (Optional show of hands.) "What did you notice — even a small ripple?" Take 3–4 observations. "Today: what happens when the person you are extending grace toward is genuinely difficult?"

ANCHOR CHART • DIFFICULT VS. UNSAFE — VISUAL SPECTRUM

Draw this spectrum **before class**. **LEFT END — EASY:** Someone you like, someone who has been kind to you. **MIDDLE — DIFFICULT:** Irritating, challenging, hard to be around. Grace is appropriate and possible. **RIGHT END — UNSAFE:** Active harm, ongoing danger. Safety is the priority. Grace is not the goal here. Bold dividing line between DIFFICULT and UNSAFE. Key message: **"The distinction between these two changes everything about what the right response is."**

OPENING • 2 MINUTES

"Grace with hard people is one of the most important — and most misunderstood — lessons of the year. It is NOT asking you to be gracious toward unsafe people. It IS asking you to notice: is this person difficult or unsafe? That distinction changes everything."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION • STEPS 1 — 2

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Difficult vs. Unsafe — The Core Distinction

8 MIN

"A difficult person is irritating, challenging, hard. An unsafe person is one with whom your safety is at risk. Grace with difficult people is one of the hardest practices of the year. But grace with unsafe people is not what this curriculum teaches — ever. That distinction changes everything about what the right response is."

Walk through the spectrum on the board with 2–3 class-generated examples.